04 - INTERVIEW GUIDES

KIABI 360° Framework

User Research Workstream | User Research and Interview Methodology Specialist
Field-use guide. All durations are planning recommendations. No KIABI access, recording approval, or participant availability is assumed.

1. Purpose

These semi-structured guides help explore real customer and employee experiences across KIABI online, store, and cross-channel journeys. Ask about actual events, not whether participants like Fittybird. Follow the participant's account; select relevant questions rather than reading the guide mechanically.

Use active listening, open and neutral questions, suitable probes, and accurate notes. Avoid proposing solutions prematurely. Documents 01-03 identify the research priorities and participant groups; this guide turns them into interview prompts. The standalone EPITECH interview presentation was not available in the repository reviewed, so apply any additional course instructions confirmed by the supervisor.

2. Method and Question Types

- **Open-ended:** invites an account. Example: "Tell me how you chose a size the last time you shopped online at KIABI."
- **Closed:** checks a specific fact, but may limit detail. Example: "Did you collect the order in store?" Follow with "What happened next?"
- **Probe:** clarifies or deepens an answer. Example: "What did you do when your size was unavailable?"
- **Leading:** suggests an answer and should be avoided. Example: "The size guide was confusing, wasn't it?" Ask instead: "How did you use the size information?"

Start broad, then ask for a recent example and its sequence. Give time to think; do not interrupt unnecessarily. Ask one question at a time, avoid judgment, and separate direct statements/observations from your interpretation. Note relevant emotion or behaviour without treating it as proof of a cause.

3. Standard Interview Structure

Recommended duration: about 30-45 minutes, adjusted to participant needs and access. This is a planning recommendation, not a confirmed KIABI requirement.

- **1. Introduction and consent (3-5 min):** Explain the study, voluntary participation, note-taking, and recording choice; confirm consent. Ask if they are ready to begin.
- **2. Background and context (5 min):** Understand relevant shopping or work context. Start general: "How do you usually shop for clothes?" or "What does a typical shift involve?"
- **3. Actual experience (15-20 min):** Ask for a recent, specific journey or situation and walk through it in order. Probe actions, information, people, and decisions.
- **4. Problems and consequences (8-10 min):** Explore difficulties, positive moments, workarounds, and effects without assuming a problem. Ask what happened as a result.
- **5. Closing (3-5 min):** Invite anything missed, thank the participant, explain next steps, and check if they have questions.

4. Customer Guide - Online Shoppers

Use for people with recent KIABI online shopping experience. Ask for the latest relevant example; skip topics that do not apply.

A. Shopping habits

- **Main:** How do you usually shop for clothes? What led you to shop online the last time?
- **Optional probes:** How often do you shop online? What was different about that occasion?
- **Listen for:** Motivations, routines, alternatives and context.

B. Product discovery

- **Main:** Walk me through how you found and compared the item. What information shaped your choice?
- **Optional probes:** What did you search, compare or save? Which details mattered?
- **Listen for:** Search paths, photos, descriptions, reviews, size information and decision cues.

C. Online experience

- **Main:** Tell me about your most recent KIABI online purchase, from first visit through checkout.
- **Optional probes:** Where did you pause, need help, or change course? What worked smoothly?
- **Listen for:** Navigation, product selection, confidence, checkout friction and positive moments.

D. Size and availability

- **Main:** How did you choose the size? What happened if your preferred item or size was unavailable?
- **Optional probes:** What alternatives did you consider? What information would you normally check?
- **Listen for:** Size choice, stock checks, substitutions, uncertainty and actual workarounds.

E. Delivery and after purchase

- **Main:** What happened after ordering, from tracking to receiving the item?
- **Optional probes:** How did the item compare with expectations? If returned or exchanged, walk me through why and how.
- **Listen for:** Delivery, item expectations, actual return reasons, exchange steps and effort. Do not assume fit caused a return.

5. Customer Guide - Physical-Store Shoppers

A. Visit motivation

- **Main:** Tell me about your most recent KIABI store visit. What brought you there and what did you expect?
- **Optional probes:** How did you choose that store? What did you plan to find?
- **Listen for:** Visit purpose, time constraints and expectations.

B. Product discovery

- **Main:** How did you look for the product, colour, or size?
- **Optional probes:** What did you do when you could not find it? Did you consider another option?
- **Listen for:** Search path, signage, availability and response to gaps.

C. Fitting room

- **Main:** Walk me through your fitting-room experience.
- **Optional probes:** What happened when you needed another size or colour? How did you request it?
- **Listen for:** Comfort, waiting, cabin-screen use if applicable, assistance, and sequence of events.

D. Employee assistance

- **Main:** Tell me about a time you asked for help, or chose not to.
- **Optional probes:** What prompted that choice? How easy was it to get help?
- **Listen for:** Customer expectations, staff interaction, access to help and helpful moments.

E. Checkout and returns

- **Main:** Describe payment at the end of the visit and any recent return or exchange.
- **Optional probes:** Were there queues or difficulties? What happened at each step?
- **Listen for:** Checkout flow, waiting, return reason and resolution, without assuming dissatisfaction.

6. Customer Guide - Omnichannel Shoppers

First verify the person has used more than one channel. Do not assume use of any service.

- **Main:** Think of a recent KIABI journey that involved online and a store. Please walk me through it from the beginning to the end.
- **Explore:** Did you search online before visiting, check availability, visit after seeing an item online, use Click & Collect or e-reservation, return an online purchase in store, use online services in store, or switch channels mid-journey? Which of these have you actually used?
- **Probes:** What prompted each transition? What information carried over or did not? What did you do next? How did the journey end?
- **Listen for:** Actual sequence, channel choice, availability checks, handoffs, repeated effort, expectations and workarounds. Record unused services as not used, not as barriers.

7. Employee Guide - Sales Assistants

- **Role and day:** What are your main responsibilities in a typical shift?
- **Customer requests:** What product, size, colour, or fitting-room help do customers commonly ask for? Tell me about a recent example.
- **Availability and fitting:** Walk me through what happens when a size is unavailable or a customer needs another size in the fitting area.
- **Tools and coordination:** Which screens, tablets, or other tools do you use in this process? How do you coordinate with stock or inventory colleagues?
- **Online-to-store:** Tell me about helping someone who researched a product online. What information or difficulties came up?
- **Process reflection:** Which steps work well, and where do delays or workarounds occur? What limits or opportunities do you see in the current process?

Probe for a specific situation, sequence, tools used, and outcome. Do not request confidential customer records or treat an employee's view as a customer finding.

8. Employee Guide - Store Managers

- **Operations:** How are customer-facing and fitting-area routines organised in your store?
- **Experience and feedback:** What customer experience issues are brought to your attention, and how is feedback collected or used?
- **Availability:** How are product or size availability questions handled and coordinated?
- **Digital tools:** What digital tools support store work, and how are changes introduced to employees?
- **Omnichannel:** Tell me about a recent operational challenge involving a customer moving between online and store channels.
- **Constraints:** What practical factors would need consideration for a future digital pilot?

Ask for process examples, not internal performance data or confidential company information. Do not presume access or authority to approve a pilot.

9. Supplementary Stakeholder Prompts

Use only if these stakeholders are recruited and access is approved.

- **Stock or inventory personnel:** How is product/size availability checked and updated? What happens when a requested size is missing? How do store and online availability processes connect, if at all?

- **E-commerce or digital team:** How are product and size details presented online? What journey data or cross-channel capabilities are available, and what limitations or definitions should researchers understand?
- **Customer service representatives:** What product, fit, size, or return questions do you handle? How are cases resolved or handed off? Please avoid identifiable customer examples.

10. Probing Question Bank

- **Clarify:** “What do you mean by that?” “Could you walk me through what happened?”
- **Behaviour:** “What did you do next?” “Did you try anything else?”
- **Emotion:** “How did that feel at the time?” “What was the most difficult or helpful part?”
- **Consequences:** “How did that affect your experience?” “What happened in the end?”
- **Decision-making:** “What mattered as you chose?” “What information did you use?” “When did this happen?”

11. Questions to Avoid

- **Leading:** Avoid “The size guide was confusing, wasn’t it?” Ask “How did you use the size information?”
- **Solution-suggesting:** Avoid “Would a virtual avatar solve this?” Ask “What did you do to judge fit?”
- **Assuming a problem:** Avoid “Why was checkout frustrating?” Ask “How was checkout for you?”
- **Double question:** Avoid “Was the item available and was checkout easy?” Ask about availability and checkout separately.
- **Yes/no only:** Avoid “Did you ask for help?” Ask “Tell me about how you got help, if you needed it.”
- **Hypothetical prediction:** Avoid “Would you use Click & Collect?” Ask “Have you used it? Tell me about that experience.” If not, record that it was not used.

12. Opening and Closing Scripts

English opening

“Hello, I am an EPITECH Master’s student conducting exploratory research for the KIABI 360° Framework. I would like to understand your real shopping or work experiences. There are no right or wrong answers. Taking part is voluntary; you may skip a question or stop. I will take notes. May I record this conversation? Recording is optional and will happen only with your permission. Notes or recordings will be handled and anonymised only as allowed by the arrangements confirmed for this study. Do you have any questions, and do you agree to participate?”

French opening

« Bonjour, je suis étudiant en Master à EPITECH et je mène une recherche exploratoire pour le KIABI 360° Framework. Je souhaite comprendre vos expériences réelles d’achat ou de travail. Il n’y a pas de bonne ou de mauvaise réponse. Votre participation est volontaire ; vous pouvez passer une question ou arrêter. Je prendrai des notes. Puis-je enregistrer cet entretien ? L’enregistrement est facultatif et ne sera effectué qu’avec votre accord. Les notes et enregistrements seront traités et anonymisés uniquement selon les modalités confirmées pour cette étude. Avez-vous des questions et acceptez-vous de participer ? »

English closing

“Thank you for your time. Is there anything about your experience that I have not asked and you would like to add? I will label the research notes with a participant ID and use them for the project analysis according to the arrangements explained today. If recording was agreed, it will be handled under those same confirmed arrangements. Do you have any final questions?”

French closing

« Merci pour votre temps. Y a-t-il un aspect de votre expérience que je n’ai pas abordé et que vous souhaitez ajouter ? Les notes de recherche seront associées à un identifiant participant et utilisées pour l’analyse du projet selon les modalités expliquées aujourd’hui. Si l’enregistrement a été autorisé, il sera traité selon ces mêmes modalités. Avez-vous une dernière question ? »

13. Interviewer Checklist

Before

☐ Review participant profile and select relevant guide. ☐ Prepare notes and approved consent information. ☐ Confirm appointment, format, language, and duration. ☐ Verify recording permission process.

During

☐ Introduce study and obtain consent. ☐ Ask open questions and listen actively. ☐ Probe neutrally; avoid leading. ☐ Take accurate notes. ☐ Separate observations from interpretation.

After

☐ Complete notes promptly. ☐ Summarise positive and difficult moments. ☐ Record unanswered questions and follow-up needs. ☐ Store materials as approved and prepare for qualitative analysis.

14. Interview Record Template

- **Participant ID:** Anonymous ID, e.g. P01
- **Category:** Customer or employee group
- **Date / format:** Date; in person or remote
- **Duration:** Actual minutes
- **Consent:** Confirmed / not confirmed
- **Recording permission:** Yes / no

- **Main topics:** Topics discussed
- **Key quotes:** Relevant statements, recorded accurately
- **Observations:** Observed behaviour or emotion
- **Initial notes:** Preliminary reflections, separate from facts
- **Follow-up needed:** Open questions for investigation

Leave fields blank until an actual interview. Do not enter fictional responses.

15. Methodological Limitations

Small qualitative samples do not represent all KIABI customers. Memories may be incomplete, interviewer bias may affect interpretation, and employees may describe different aspects from customers. Reduce these limits by asking for recent specific events, listening actively, using neutral probes, keeping accurate notes, separating observation from inference, and comparing accounts across participants. Treat findings as exploratory and avoid unsupported generalisations.

16. Next Steps

Document completed interviews in 05 - Interview Records, then synthesise evidence in 06 - Interview Analysis, 07 - Empathy Maps, and 08 - Customer Journey Maps. Do not treat unverified assumptions as findings.